Just the will to give or lend,
This will make you someone's friend.

Be a friend. You don't need glory.
Friendship is a simple story.
Pass by trifling errors blindly,
Gaze on honest effort kindly,
Cheer the youth, who's bravely trying,
Pity him who's sadly sighing;
Just a little labour spend
On the duties of a friend.

Be a friend. The pay is bigger
(Though not written by a figure)
That is earned by people clever
In what's merely self-endeavour.
You'll have friends instead of neighbours
For the profits of your labours;
You'll be richer in the end
Than a prince, if you're a friend.



e. Complete the summary of the poem given below with suitable words.

In the first stanza, the poet explains that it doesn't cost any ..... to be a ..... . We just need to be ....., helpful and be willing to ..... others. The second stanza links to some of the ..... of friendship. We should ..... our friends' little mistakes,..... them in whatever they are trying to do and feel ..... when they are sad. Lastly, the third stanza points out that although ..... people who work for their own benefit do earn a lot of ....., we can earn more valuable wealth by being ..... Then, all of our ..... will be our friends and that makes us richer than a ..... .

f. The poet uses certain expressions in the poem to suggest something to the readers. Study the suggestions given in the box. Choose an apt one that fits the expressions given in the table.

money earned	silly mistakes	hard work	selfish
self striving	helping nature	a happy character	

12th Communicative English Book.indb 5 02/02/19 5:09 PM